EquWord Quick Start for Windows

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Document version 1.0.0

Software version 1.0.0

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Document information

- Microsoft Word 16.0.20430.20180 (64-bit)
- Windows 11 Home build 26300
- Repository: https://github.com/PsycheMatrica/EquWord
- Use this guide with desktop Word for Windows to load EquWord, prepare a manuscript, and practice equation conversion and formatting. Mac users should use the separate Mac guide.
- Copyright 2026 Gyeongcheol Cho. The software and original guide content are licensed under CC BY-NC-SA 4.0. See LICENSE.txt and https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-sa/4.0/. Microsoft retains rights in its Word interface and trademarks shown in the instructional screenshots. Using the formatter does not by itself place your manuscript or equations under that license.

Find Word's Startup Folder

1. Extract the distribution ZIP and keep EquWord.dotm in its extracted folder for now. Use desktop Microsoft Word for Windows; Word for the web cannot run the template. Save your manuscript as a .docx working copy so its equations remain editable.

2. In Word, choose File > Options > Advanced. Scroll to General and select File Locations. In the File types list, select Startup, not Documents, and choose Modify. See Figure 1.

3. Copy the current full folder path from the Modify Location dialog. In a folder dialog, clicking the address bar shows a path you can copy. Select Cancel to leave the folder unchanged, then select Close in File Locations and Cancel in Word Options. Keep the copied path for the next section. See Figure 2.

Notes

• Find the Startup folder for this Word installation; do not substitute Documents or assume a fixed path. Screenshot usernames are anonymized as userID.

• Use macros only when permitted by your normal Word or organization policy. If the template is blocked, follow the normal approval process or ask your administrator. Do not enable all macros or change VBA-project access settings for EquWord.

Figure 1

Select Startup in Word's File Locations

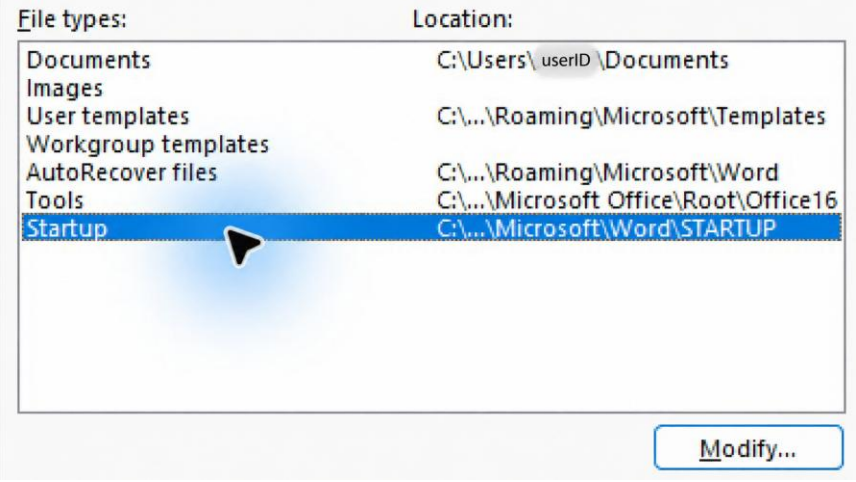


Figure 2

Copy the Current Startup Folder Path



Install EquWord for Automatic Loading

4. Save your work and close all Word windows. Open File Explorer, paste the copied Startup path into the address bar, and press Enter.

5. Copy EquWord.dotm from the extracted distribution into that Startup folder. If an older formatter template is already there, move the older file to a backup folder outside Startup first. Keep only the current EquWord.dotm in Startup; do not overwrite unrelated templates.

6. Reopen Word and open your manuscript or practice copy. Press Alt+F8, choose EquWord_About, and select Run. Confirm version 1.0.0 and the CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 license. EquWord should now be available each time Word starts. See Figure 3.

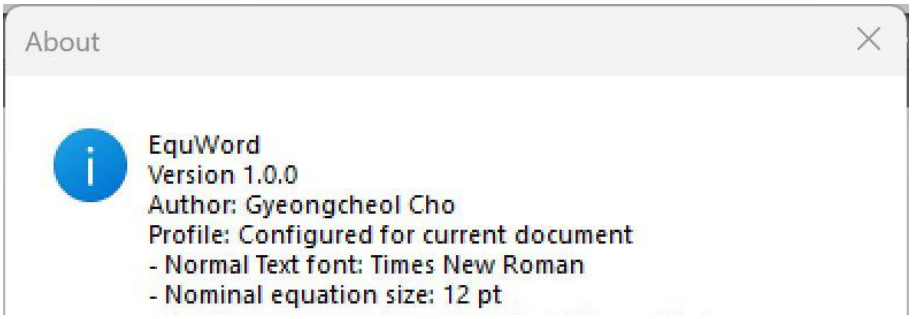
Notes

• You do not need to import .bas, .cls or UserForm files. EquWord.dotm already contains the VBA project. Your manuscript stays a .docx file and does not need to be saved as .docm.

• For a temporary session only, use File > Options > Add-ins, set Manage to Word Add-ins and select Go. Choose Add, select EquWord.dotm, leave its checkbox selected, and select OK. This alternative must be repeated after restarting Word unless the template is installed in Startup.

Figure 3

Confirm EquWord 1.0.0 Is Loaded



Add Convenient Command Buttons

7. With EquWord loaded, choose File > Options > Customize Ribbon and set Choose commands from to Macros. Create a New Tab named EquWord and rename its custom group Commands.

8. Add the required EquWord_* macros to that group. Use Rename to choose short button labels and icons, then select OK. See Figure 4, panels A and B.

9. For Quick Access Toolbar buttons, choose File > Options > Quick Access Toolbar. Set Choose commands from to Macros, add frequent commands, and use Modify for their labels or icons. Select OK.

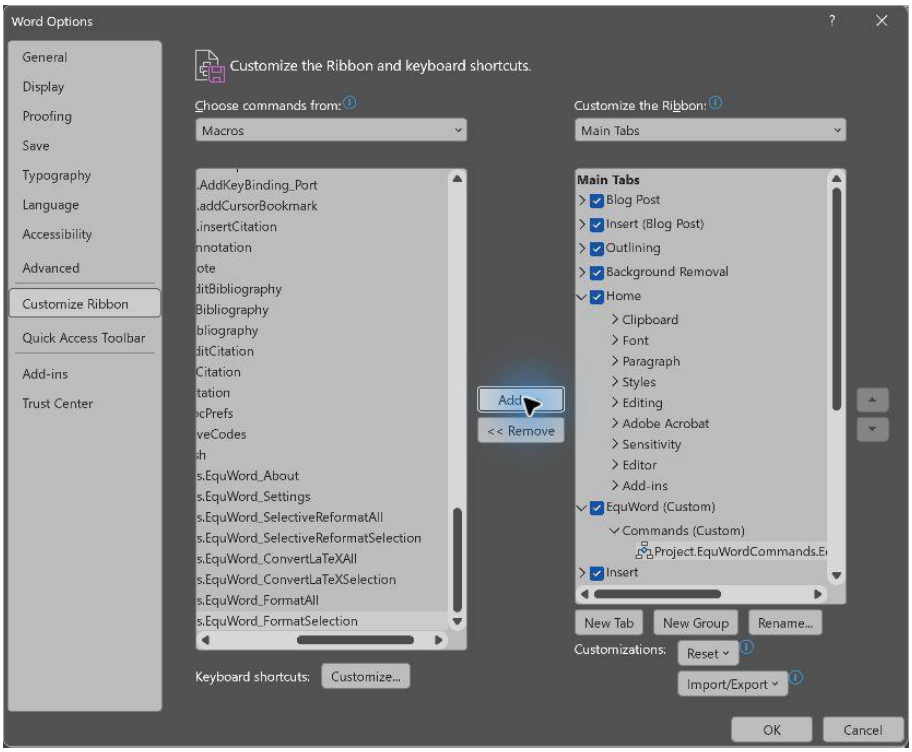
Notes

- Common buttons: EquWord_Settings — Settings; EquWord_FormatSelection — Format selection; EquWord_ConvertLaTeXSelection — Convert LaTeX; EquWord_SelectiveReformatSelection — Selective reformat.
- Buttons are optional and require EquWord to remain loaded. Alt+F8 runs the same commands. These personal Word customizations are not created automatically by loading EquWord.
- Short labels such as FormatEquSelected are user-defined; the underlying macro remains EquWord_FormatSelection. Whole-document commands and EquWord_About can be added if useful.
- To match panel B, choose Show Below the Ribbon from Customize Quick Access Toolbar. Choose Show Command Labels if available.

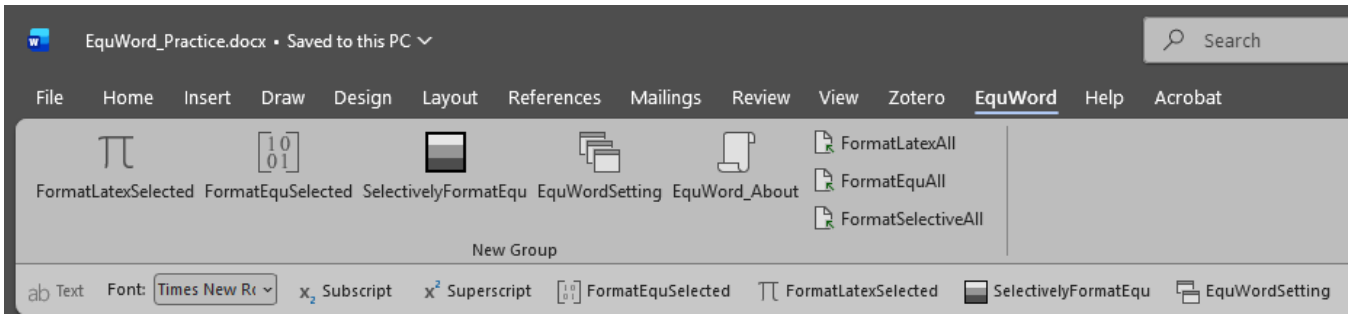
Figure 4

Customize EquWord Command Buttons

A. Configure the Ribbon



B. Example custom tab and Quick Access Toolbar



Save Settings for This Manuscript

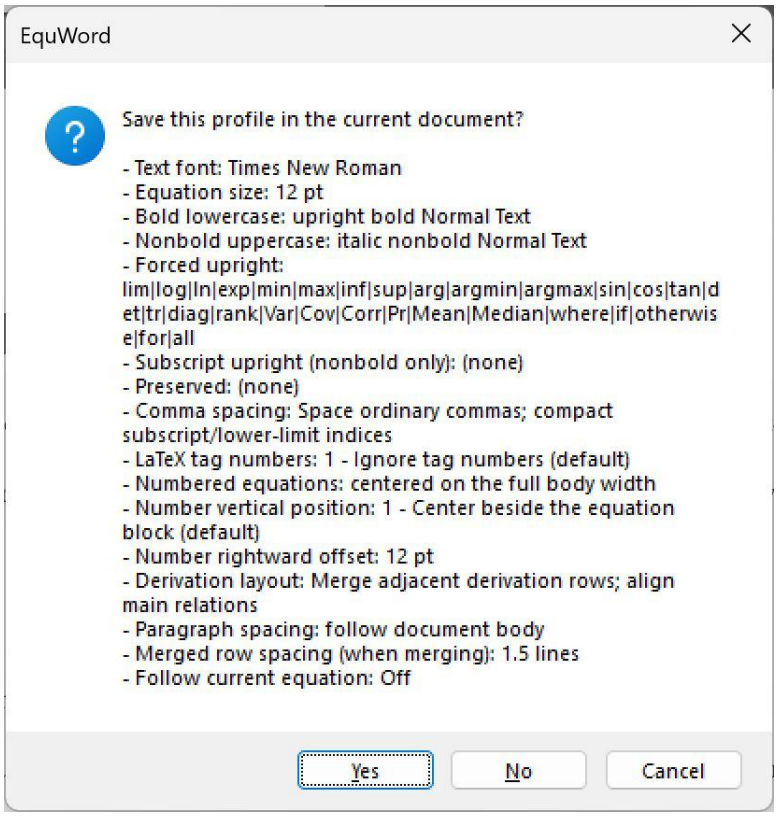
10. Activate the manuscript or practice document you want to format. Run EquWord_Settings using your Settings button or Alt+F8. Review the prompts and final summary, choose Yes to save the profile, then save the .docx file.

Notes

- For a first test, use Times New Roman 12 pt, merging option 2, 1.5-line rows (option 2), and the default 12 pt number offset. Equation paragraphs follow the body spacing; merged rows use the separate internal setting. Recheck saved profiles after an update. See Figure 5.
- Follow current equation controls whether Word displays the equation being processed. It is separate from the formatting categories. EquWord_About shows the settings currently stored in the active document.
- These settings govern typography and layout. EquWord does not check whether an equation is mathematically correct.

Figure 5

Review the Manuscript Settings Before Formatting



Run the First Examples

11. In Exercise 1 of your practice copy, select the complete literal source \[y = x + 1 \], including both delimiters. Run EquWord_ConvertLaTeXSelection and confirm the intended scope and settings.

12. Read the result dialog and review notes. Click inside the result and confirm one editable native Word equation showing y equals x plus one, without unwanted outer brackets. Save the practice copy.

13. In Exercise 2, click inside the existing native equation and run EquWord_FormatSelection. This formats native equations without LaTeX conversion.

14. For a separate conversion check, type \[v = \frac{1}{2} + \alpha \] in a fresh paragraph. Select the complete source and run EquWord_ConvertLaTeXSelection. Confirm that the fraction and Greek alpha remain editable (Figure 6).

15. In Exercise 3, select both complete equation paragraphs in the left cell of the numbered table. With merging and 1.5-line rows selected in EquWord_Settings, run EquWord_FormatSelection. Check one editable two-row block aligned at the equals signs, with its original number (Figure 7).

16. To change only some categories, run EquWord_SelectiveReformatSelection. Choose Deselect all, select the required categories, and choose Run (Figure 8). Select all restores all categories.

Notes

- Turn Track Changes off and work in the main document body. Headers, footnotes, endnotes and text boxes are outside these commands' scope. Select only the source, not the surrounding instructions.
- When merging, select the complete group in the left cell and retain its number in the right cell. A cursor in only one row requests single-equation processing. The outer equation paragraph continues to follow body spacing.
- Accepted category choices and Follow current equation are remembered for the document. Line spacing and equation-number table placement can be selected independently; multiline merge and alignment also applies line spacing. Structure, number-field and bookmark checks always run.
- EquWord_ConvertLaTeXAll processes supported source throughout the main body. EquWord_FormatAll formats native equations in that scope, and EquWord_SelectiveReformatAll applies selected categories. Use these only for intended whole-body processing; use selection commands for one block.

Figure 6

Inspect the Fraction and Greek Symbol

$$v = \frac{1}{2} + \alpha$$

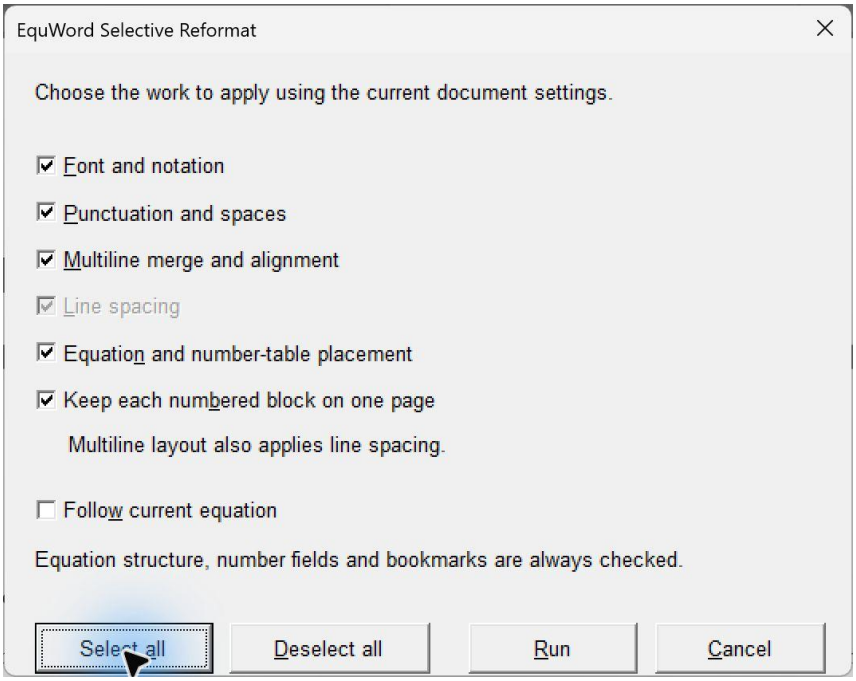
Figure 7

Review the Merged Numbered Block

$$\begin{aligned} x &= 1 + 1 \\ &= 2 \end{aligned} \tag{1}$$

Figure 8

Choose Categories in EquWord Selective Reformat



Review and Save the Result

17. Read the result dialog and any review notes. Check the equations and neighboring prose, equation numbers and cross-references, multiline alignment, and page breaks. Save the working copy once you are satisfied.

Notes

- During a run, Word's caption reports the current task and elapsed time. On Windows, Esc requests a stop at the next safe checkpoint. A current Word operation may delay cancellation. Completed edits remain, so review the working copy before saving.
- If a block is retained for manual review, inspect the reported reason. After editing a group, select the complete group again when you want to remerge it. Use whole-document commands only when you intend to process the entire main body.

Citing EquWord

If EquWord contributed to equation preparation in your manuscript, please consider citing the software in the Acknowledgments or another appropriate section. Cite the version you actually used. Citation is optional when using EquWord. Use only statements that reflect your actual use. Adjust the tools, tasks, software version, and singular or plural author wording as needed.

Example of software use

Equations were prepared in Microsoft Word using EquWord (Version 1.0.0; Cho, 2026).

Optional example involving ChatGPT

Use this combined example only if you also used ChatGPT for drafting and revision.

> **Acknowledgments**
>
> ChatGPT (OpenAI) assisted with drafting and revision. The authors reviewed the AI-assisted content and take responsibility for the final manuscript. Equations were prepared in Microsoft Word using EquWord (Version 1.0.0; Cho, 2026).

Reference

Cho, G. (2026). *EquWord: Equation conversion and formatting for Microsoft Word* (Version 1.0.0) [Computer software]. https://github.com/PsycheMatrica/EquWord

Use the released version's DOI when available.

Appendix: Command Reference

Table 1

Formatter Commands and Their Uses

Command	When to use it
EquWord_Settings	Set or update the current manuscript profile.
EquWord_FormatSelection	Format selected native equations, or one at the cursor.
EquWord_FormatAll	Format native equations throughout the main body.
EquWord_ConvertLaTeXSelection	Convert supported selected literal LaTeX and format it.
EquWord_ConvertLaTeXAll	Convert supported literal LaTeX and format the main body.
EquWord_SelectiveReformatSelection	Choose categories for selected native equations.
EquWord_SelectiveReformatAll	Choose categories throughout the main body.
EquWord_About	Show the loaded version and active document settings.